

Lawrence Chengzhi Zhao

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EMPLOYMENT

Texas Tech University, Rawls College of Business
Assistant Professor of Finance

Lubbock, Texas
2023–Present

EDUCATION

Rice University
Ph.D., M.A., Finance

Houston, Texas
2017–2023

Baylor University
M.S., Economics

Waco, Texas
2015–2017

Baylor University
B.B.A., Finance and Mathematics

Waco, Texas
2012–2015

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Empirical Corporate Finance, Household Finance, Competition, Financial Intermediation

WORKING PAPERS

Government Litigation Risk and the Decline in Low-Income Mortgage Lending

with Scott Frame, Kristopher Gerardi, Erik Mayer, and Billy Xu

Revise & Resubmit at the Journal of Financial Economics

Best Paper Semifinalist at the Financial Management Association Annual Meeting, 2023

The Real Effects of Antitrust Enforcement on Corporate Decisions: Evidence from the Courts

Out of Sight, Out of Mind: Search Frictions and Financial Adviser Misconduct

WORK IN PROGRESS

Pension Performance and Labor Outcomes, with Billy Xu and Zhen Ye

Underwriter Competition and Rent Extraction, with Gustavo Grullon

PRESENTATIONS

(*) indicates presentation by a coauthor, (s) indicates scheduled presentation

2025: Midwest Finance Association*, UNC Annual Conference on Market-Based Solutions for Reducing Wealth Inequality, Financial Intermediation Research Society Conference*

2024: American Economic Association, INSEAD*, Australian National University*, University of Virginia (Department of Economics)*, American Real Estate and Urban Economics Association (International)*, American Real Estate and Urban Economics Association, Texas Tech University (Rawls), Emory University (Goizueta)*, Hoyt Institute*, University of Maryland Junior Finance Conference*, Eastern Finance Association*, FSU-UF Critical Issues in Real Estate Symposium, FDIC Bank Research Conference, Lone Star Finance Conference, Virtual Household Finance Seminar*, University of Wisconsin-Madison (Wisconsin School of Business)*, Cornell Real Estate Symposium*, University of Rochester (Simon)*

2023 and before: Federal Reserve Bank of Atlanta*, Federal Reserve Bank of Philadelphia*, INFORMS*, Boca-ECGI Corporate Finance and Governance Conference*, Texas Tech University (Rawls), Eastern Finance Association (×2), Financial Management Association (×3), Rice University (Jones; ×3)

ACADEMIC SERVICE

Ad Hoc Journal Referee

Financial Analysts Journal

Committee Participation

FMA Annual Meeting Program Committee 2025

Conference Discussions

Small Mortgages and the Rise of FinTech and Shadow Banks, *Yongqiang Chu, David Zhang, and Tim Zhang* (AREUEA 2024)

Banking on Trust: Supervisory Transparency in Developing Economies, *Abhiman Das, Tanmoy Majilla, and Rimmy Tomy* (EFA 2024)

The Real Effect of Sociopolitical Racial Animus: Mutual Fund Manager Performance During the AAPI Hate, *Vikas Agarwal, Wei Jiang, Yuchen Luo, and Hong Zou* (FMA 2023)

Impact of Robo-advisors on Financial Advisors' Labor Market, *Ishitha Kumar* (EFA 2023)

TEACHING

Texas Tech University, Rawls College of Business, Instructor

Corporate Finance I (UG)	2023, 2024, 2025
Seminar in Special Topics in Finance (Ph.D.)	2025

Rice University, Jesse H. Jones Graduate School of Business, Teaching Assistant

Financial Management (UG)	2021, 2022
Mergers and Acquisitions (MBA)	2019, 2021, 2022, 2023
Applied Finance (MBA)	2019
Core Finance (MBA)	2019
Corporate Investment Policy (MBA)	2019
Applied Risk Management (MBA)	2018
Managerial Economics (MBA)	2017

AWARDS AND HONORS

Jesse H. Jones Graduate School of Business Ph.D. Fellowship	2017–2023
HSB Graduate Fellowship	2015–2017
Provosts Gold Scholarship	2012–2015

SKILLS

Programming: Stata, Python, Matlab, Bloomberg, L^AT_EX

Languages: English, Chinese